Behind the Shelter Doors

01 Geography · 02 Outcomes · 03 Changes · 04 Beyond

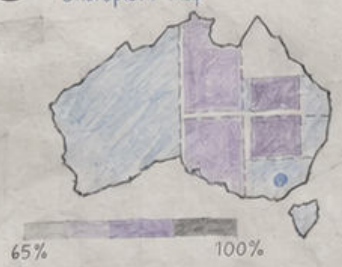
How do shelter outcomes differ for dogs and cats across Australia's RSPCA network?

01 Where do outcomes differ?

Three maps compare live-release rate, caseload and selected facility locations.

1 Live-release outcomes

Choropleth map



Colour = % animals released alive

2 Where are animals recorded?

Proportional symbol map



Circle area = number of animals

3 Verified RSPCA facilities

Point location map



Points = verified facility examples

02 What happens to dogs and cats?

Compare species, recorded outcomes, euthanasia reasons and state-level patterns.

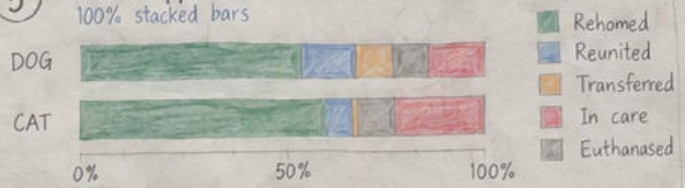
4 How wide is the dog-cat gap?

Dumbbell chart



5 What happens after intake?

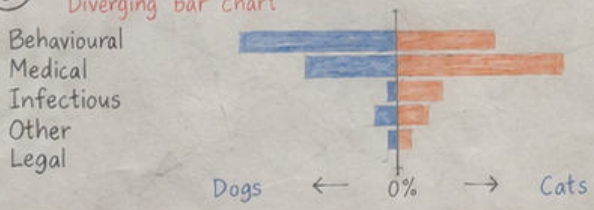
100% stacked bars



Cats rehomed 64.1% | Dogs reunited 24.8%

6 Why does euthanasia happen?

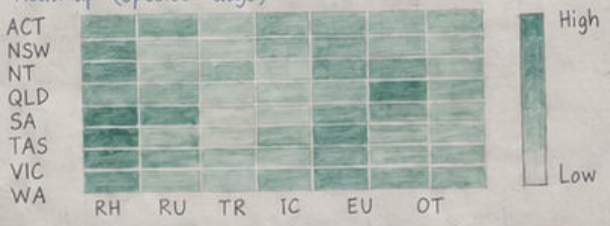
Diverging bar chart



Dog behavioural 59.7% | Cat medical 46.7%

7 How do outcomes vary by state?

Heatmap (species: dogs)



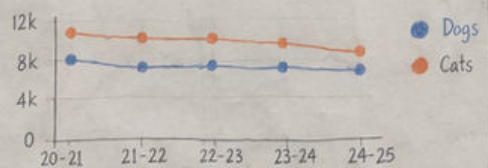
NT euthanased 26.4% | NSW rehomed 58.3%

03 How do reported caseloads change?

RSPCA five-year trends, annual rank changes and records attributed to outcomes.

8 Recorded caseload: five-year trend

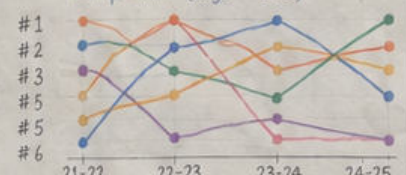
Line chart (Jurisdiction: QLD ∨)



Dogs 7,424 → 6,401 | Cats 10,983 → 8,019

9 Jurisdiction rank by annual change

Bump chart (dogs + cats)



2024-25: #1 SA (-9.7%), #6 VIC (-18.4%)

10 Species → recorded outcomes

Sankey diagram (2024-25)



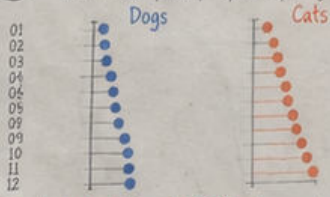
Cats rehomed 16,445 | Dogs reunited 3,930

04 Beyond the shelter walls

Foster placement episodes, changing cat shares and one local seasonal case study.

11 Victorian foster-care placements

Faceted dot plots | Top 12 reporting entities



12 selected entities | 13,797 placement episodes

12 Foster-care concentration

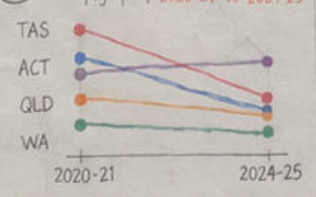
Treemap (area = share of episodes)



Cats 83.4% | North Melbourne 30.1%

13 Has the share of cats changed?

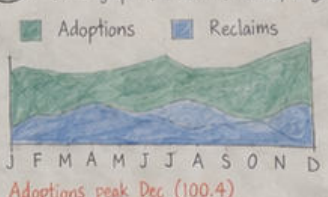
Slopegraph | 2020-21 vs 2024-25



TAS cat share 89.1% → 64.9% (-25.0%)

14 When do adoptions and reclaims peak?

Streamgraph (Townsville, monthly avg)



Adoptions peak Dec (100.4)
Reclaims peak May (84.4)

Key takeaways:

- Outcomes vary across states and between species.
- Cats face higher euthanasia rates and lower rehoming.
- Fostering and targeted programs can improve outcomes.

Sources: RSPCA 2020-25
Animal Welfare Victoria 2025
Townsville 2021-25

Author: Your Name
Course: FIT3170 Data Visualisation
Date: 10 Apr 2025
Tool: Hand-drawn sketch (planning)
A1: New data visualisation